

IN THE SENATE

SENATE RESOLUTION NO. 118

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A SENATE RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE SENATE AND PROPOSING THE CREATION OF A STATE PLAN FOR KINSHIP CAREGIVERS IN ORDER TO PROVIDE A COMPREHENSIVE BLUEPRINT TO ENSURE THAT INITIATIVES AND ACTIONS IMPLEMENTED TO SUPPORT KINSHIP CAREGIVERS ARE COORDINATED AND TO MAXIMIZE THE USE OF PUBLIC AND COMMUNITY-BASED RESOURCES.

Be It Resolved by the Senate of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, kinship caregivers are grandparents, other adult family members, or close family friends who are raising children when such children's parents are unable to do so; and

WHEREAS, kinship caregivers offer children permanency and improved well-being and reduce dependency on the foster care system; and

WHEREAS, for every one Idaho child in foster care being raised by kin, there are 18 being raised by kin outside of foster care; and

WHEREAS, more than 10,000 children in Idaho are being raised by their grandparents; and

WHEREAS, more than 43,000 children are living in homes where a relative is the head of household; and

WHEREAS, the dedication and selflessness of kinship caregivers enhance the quality of life for those they care for, often sacrificing their time, energy, emotional and physical health, financial stability, and personal goals to provide care and support; and

WHEREAS, the absence of a solid support structure for kinship caregivers, including access to resources and respite care, takes a serious toll on the economic and social well-being of families and businesses and communities across Idaho; and

WHEREAS, kinship caregivers and those they care for would benefit from a multi-sector state-planning initiative to connect public, private, and independent sectors to transform the infrastructure and coordination of services.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Senate, assembled in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, that the Senate endorses the efforts of the Idaho caregiver alliance to develop a state plan for kinship caregivers and recommendations to increase public awareness, to provide training for caregivers, to improve caregiver supports, including respite resources, to integrate support for kinship caregivers into education and health care systems, and to develop methods for ongoing data collection and reporting to monitor changes and assure responsible use of public and private resources.